

WHY-HOW

PRIMARY WHY · SECONDARY HOW · TERTIARY WHAT

# How the WHY-HOW communicates

How your wiring shows up in writing and speech, how each orientation hears it, and the three adjustments that buy the most understanding.

## HOW YOU NATURALLY WRITE

Your messages build understanding: context, pattern, mechanism, meaning. You explain how the pieces connect and why the whole matters, often in the same breath, and length scales with the richness of the picture. What thins out is motion: dates, owners, the ask itself. A reader can finish your message genuinely wiser and still not know what happens next, or when.

### Your signature

#### PRESENT

- + Vision and pattern language: “the system”, “how it connects”, “what this really means”
- + Mechanism woven into meaning: because-chains and dependencies
- + Careful terms, definitions, and honest distinctions
- + Both question signatures: the reframe and the boundary test

#### CONSPICUOUSLY ABSENT

- Dates, deadlines, and any sense of clock
- Named owners and a stated ask
- Shipping language: “done”, “locked”, “next step”
- The status-update register altogether

## HOW YOU LAND

### WHY readers

Hear a native speaker. Your connections energize them; long is fine, they were going to think about it anyway.

### WHAT readers

Finish reading and ask, “so what do you need from me?” The missing ask reads as indecision, and depth reads as delay.

### HOW readers

Trust your mechanism talk and engage the detail. They may still want the sequence: what happens first.

## THE BLIND SPOT

Insight without an ask is a gift the reader does not know what to do with. To a WHAT reader, a message with no owner, no date, and no next step does not read as thoughtful, it reads as unfinished, however complete the thinking. The single sentence you resist writing, “I need X from you by Friday”, is the one that makes the rest of the message land.

### For WHAT readers

Lead with the ask. One line up top: what you need, from whom, by when, marked “proposed” if you are unsure. The understanding follows for those who read on.

### For HOW readers

Sequence the mechanism. Your connections are rich; give them an order. “First, then, unless” turns a web into a path someone can execute.

### Everywhere

Cap the context. One paragraph of framing, then the substance. If the picture needs more, append it, do not make the reader earn the point.